

MOHIT SHARMA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Threat researcher with hands-on experience in emerging-threat and vulnerability intelligence at Microsoft Defender (MDVM), malware reverse engineering, and OSINT. Tracks threat actors, TTPs, and exploitation activity across MITRE ATT&CK, builds threat-intel tooling and automation, and turns raw findings into defensible advisories. Volunteer OSINT investigator supporting foreign law-enforcement casework.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Threat Intelligence & OSINT:** Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI), threat-actor & TTP tracking, alias/persona correlation, emerging-threat monitoring, threat hunting, IOC extraction & enrichment (VirusTotal), OSINT tradecraft & corroboration, breach-data analysis & victim mapping, attack-surface & exposure assessment
- Frameworks & Standards:** MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, Diamond Model, the intelligence cycle, exploitability prioritization (CVSS, EPSS, CISA KEV), ISO/IEC 27001, ISO/IEC 42001, PCI DSS, Zero Trust
- Detection & Response:** detection engineering, SIEM, KQL/Kusto (Azure Data Explorer), Microsoft Defender (MDE / MDVM), EDR telemetry analysis, incident response, endpoint hardening (WDAC, AppLocker, Smart App Control); DFIR (Velociraptor, KAPE, Volatility)
- Malware & Reverse Engineering:** static & dynamic analysis, fuzzing, YARA, IDA Pro, Ghidra, x64dbg, GDB, malware-family & C2 tradecraft
- Programming & Automation:** Python, Go, C++, Bash, Rust, x86-64 Assembly, KQL, regex; Git, CI/CD, AI-assisted research & triage
- Cloud & Infrastructure:** Azure (Entra ID, Azure Data Explorer), AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Active Directory; SQLite, MySQL, MongoDB

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft - Security Researcher

Microsoft Defender Vulnerability Management (MDVM) · Hyderabad, India · Jun 2025 – Present

- Triaged emerging-threat CVEs end to end for severity, real-world exposure, and detection coverage on high-severity on-call, including the actively-exploited Copy Fail, Dirty Frag, and Fragnesia Linux-kernel privilege-escalation family (CVE-2026-43600) and a nation-state Cisco ASA CVE (CVSS 9.9) that went unflagged because the device-discovery pipeline skipped OS-version normalization; carried **22 of 31** tracked CVEs to case-closure and shipped the enrichment fix that restored ASA coverage.
- Root-caused data-normalization and version-mapping defects across **10+ products** (Adobe Acrobat, Teams, Telegram) in an org-wide detection-accuracy program; shipped **9 of 10** program specs for data ingestion and normalization, cutting false-positive incidents **47% (511 resolved)**.
- Authored a **Security Configuration Assessment (SCA)** to disable Remote Registry, an RPC-based lateral-movement and remote-enumeration vector abused for credential and registry-hive access; quantified real-world event signal-to-noise across the fleet to prove the control could be enforced safely at scale, and shipped the recommendation to General Availability.
- Reconstructed the full kill chain of a nation-state intrusion by **Midnight Blizzard** that deployed **INC ransomware**, correlating endpoint and identity telemetry to trace the operator from credential theft through C2 and hands-on Rclone exfiltration across an on-prem-to-Entra pivot, then delivered the IOC narrative that drove proactive containment.
- Traced a hands-on-keyboard operator across EDR telemetry (Impacket, a Cobalt Strike SMB beacon, registry SecretsDump, and Mimikatz) as they escalated from local admin to domain admin, delivering the attack-story timeline used to validate detection coverage.
- Built an **LLM-based CVE-triage agent** that automated first-pass coverage assessment across Kusto clusters, generating standardized reports, tickets, and ready-to-merge fixes, and reaching parity with the team's adopted triage tooling.

Hacker4Justice - Volunteer OSINT Investigator

Remote · Jun 2025 – Jun 2026

- Performed OSINT (people/entity research, alias/persona correlation, cross-source corroboration) on a CSAM marketplace dataset of **4,800+ suspect credentials**.
- De-anonymized suspects behind throwaway accounts from minimal starting selectors, reaching a **23% positive-identification rate**.
- Produced documented suspect reports and IOC packages under OPSEC-aware source handling for law-enforcement referral on a case that has identified **44+ buyers and sellers**.

Microsoft - Security Researcher Intern

Hyderabad, India · May 2024 – Jul 2024

- Reverse-engineered **8 malware families** (incl. Turla and Agent Tesla) via static/dynamic analysis and OSINT; authored YARA rules yielding **50,000+ detections** and automated VirusTotal feed analysis, cutting detection time from ~2 hours to near real-time.
- Ran a **Diamond Model** threat hunt on the **Turla APT**, pivoting across adversary, capability, infrastructure, and victim to build a structured intrusion picture and drive hypothesis-based hunting and attribution.
- Applied **fuzzing** to mutate malicious and benign inputs, surfacing detection blind spots and hardening YARA and behavioral signatures against evasion and variant drift for more resilient coverage.

PROJECTS

ExploitRank - Threat-Intelligence Platform · Go · github.com/rinzoocrux/exploitrank

- Engineered a self-hosted CLI + offline dashboard that ingests public CVE / threat-intel feeds (CISA KEV, NVD, EPSS, GitHub Advisories, OSV, public-PoC index), auto-tags **MITRE ATT&CK techniques**, threat-actor aliases (~170 groups), and defanged IOCs, then generates a **daily threat advisory**.
- Built an offline **actor-to-malware-to-technique relationship graph** from the MITRE ATT&CK STIX knowledge base, connecting current reporting to known actors and their tooling across **~17k relationships**.

Malware-Analysis Lab & SIEM · FLARE-VM, REMnux, YARA, SIEM

- Built a **SIEM** around a self-hosted **malware-analysis lab** that doubles as a closed-loop range for **detection engineering** and **threat hunting**, ingesting detonation and endpoint telemetry to author, test, and tune **detection rules** and **YARA** signatures against live malware behavior.

Command-and-Control (C2) Framework · C++, Qt, Win32 API

- Built a C2 server and custom agent for **malware simulation** with asynchronous multi-threaded communication and task scheduling, demonstrating hands-on adversary tradecraft and tooling internals.

EDUCATION

Chitkara University, Punjab - B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering Aug 2021 – Aug 2025 · CGPA: 9.25 / 10

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Cosmos DB Developer Specialty (DP-420)

LANGUAGES

English (professional) · Hindi · Japanese (JLPT N4)